

Faction Reputation System — Inkglass Odyssey

Design document. Read before working on relay/factions/, faction endpoints, or shop pricing logic.

Cross-references: docs/economy_balance.md (sell-back ratio modifiers), docs/schemas_reference.md (faction.json).

Standing Tiers

Faction standing is a numerical value (-100 to 100) tracked per player per faction in the character sheet's `faction_standing` field.

Standing tier	Range	Effects
Hostile	-100 to -51	NPCs refuse service, may attack on sight, locked out of faction quests
Unfriendly	-50 to -1	Shop prices +25%, limited quest access, NPCs are curt/unhelpful
Neutral	0	Default for new characters. Standard prices, basic quest access
Friendly	1 to 50	Shop prices -10%, expanded quest access, NPCs share rumours
Allied	51 to 100	Shop prices -20%, full quest access, rare inventory unlocked, faction abilities available

Reputation Change Sources

Source	Typical range
Quest completion	+5 to +15
Quest failure	-5 to -10
Helping a faction NPC	+1 to +3
Harming a faction NPC	-5 to -15

Propagation

Factions carry `allied_factions` and `rival_factions` arrays. Reputation changes propagate automatically:

- Allied factions: +50% of the change (gaining 10 rep → allies gain +5)
- Rival factions: -25% of the change (gaining 10 rep → rivals lose -2.5, floored to integers)

The relay enforces propagation — never relies on manual tracking. The PATCH `/factions/{world_id}/{faction_id}/standing` endpoint applies propagation automatically when processing a standing change.

Schema

`faction.json` fields: `id` (string), `world` (string), `name` (string), `description` (string), `allied_factions` (array of faction IDs), `rival_factions` (array of faction IDs), `reputation_thresholds` (map of tier label → minimum value, allowing per-faction customisation; defaults: hostile: -51, unfriendly: -1, neutral: 0, friendly: 1, allied: 51), `shop_price_modifiers` (map of tier label → price multiplier), `notable_npcs` (array of `npc_ids` affiliated with this faction).